

Meeting with Rachel & Mat

Chick-fil-A, Inc. — Advanced Analytics & Automation

Goal: learn how they think about field-built tools and where the gaps are — and build the relationship. A conversation, not a pitch. Throughline: **these tools exist to make the team's life easier; the operational wins came after.**

QUICK LAUNCH — LIVE DEMOS (CLICK)

★ Gallery (home base)

Uniform Request

Time-Off Request

Payroll System

Schedule Counter

H.E.A.R.D. Log

Catering Quote

OPEN WITH THIS (VERBATIM-ISH)

“Every one of these started the same way — I wanted to make life easier for my team. Let people put in their own time off, order a uniform and know **exactly what comes out of their check**, see their pay clearly. That turned out to be the best retention tool I have — **turnover's down 53 points year over year**. I'd love to show you a few and hear how you all think about this.”

1. Why I build — people first

0:00 – 0:04

- Say the opener. I lead people; the software just protects their time.
- The pattern, one sentence: *trigger* → *pipeline* → *cache* → *web app* → *email*, maintainable by editing a spreadsheet.
- Tone: “I’m here to learn how you all approach this as much as to show it.”

2. The team-member experience

0:04 – 0:14

► Open: Uniform Request

► Open: Time-Off Request

- **Uniform Request:** pick items and sizes; the team member sees **each item's price and exactly what comes out of each paycheck** before submitting. No payday surprises.
- **Time-Off Request:** a team member files their own PTO from their phone — pick dates, submit. No catching a manager, no waiting on a text. Both forms bilingual (English & Spanish).
- The point: **dignity and time back**. People handle their own stuff without asking permission for everything.

“This is the part that actually moves retention — people feel respected when they don't have to chase a manager to take a day off or guess what a uniform costs them.”

3. Where it lands — Payroll

0:14 – 0:22

► Open: Payroll System

Overtime → Upload Data → “Try with Sample Files” → drag both → Analyze Overtime Data

- Those PTO/uniform requests flow into one payroll system with the math already done.
- Technical depth: cross-location OT reconciliation — under 40 at each store but over 40 combined is legally owed OT neither location catches alone (FLSA). Show the 8 multi-location employees flagged.
- Result: **payroll processing 2–3 hr → 30 min**.

4. Schedules around real lives — Schedule Counter

0:22 – 0:30

► Open: Schedule Counter

“Try with a Sample File” → drag HotSchedules → Convert → drag CSV → Generate Analysis

- Tie it to people: say yes when life happens, build the schedule around it — that’s where the turnover number came from.
- And it holds productivity: SPLH, sales-curve weighting, exponential smoothing. **SPLH \$84.42 → \$91.02** (past the \$90 goal, since Feb 2025).

5. Rapid-fire the rest

0:30 – 0:34

► Open: H.E.A.R.D. Log

► Open: Catering Quote

- **H.E.A.R.D. Log** (“Why this works”): phone-number tracking auto-flags repeat complainers.
- **Catering Quote**: **10–20 min → 2–3 min** per quote. Gesture, don’t deep-dive.

6. The numbers it moved + how it lasts

0:34 – 0:39

- **Turnover –53.50 pts YoY** · **Retention +11.21 pts YoY** · top 4% of the chain for profitability · food cost gap 1.02% → 0.74%.
- “The relationship work is the strategy — the tools just protect people’s time so we can do it.”
- Built to last: idempotent setup, config in the sheet, a non-technical manager maintains it; I run a risk-audit scanner on my own code; honest that it’s built for two stores today.

7. Questions for them — spend real time here (0:39 – 0:45)

- Where does corporate already solve these, and where am I filling gaps that shouldn’t have to be field-built?
- How do you all think about field-built tools — is there a path for them, or a reason to keep them at arm’s length?
- What would it take to do something like this at scale — and what would you change about how I’ve approached it?
- If I wanted to do more of this kind of work, what should I be learning?

Close: “I’d love to stay connected and learn how you all approach this.”

Tools that give the team their time back

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Every tool here started the same way: I wanted to make life easier for my team. Give people back their **time**, a little **privacy**, and a say in their own week — and they stop leaving. The operational wins came after, almost as a byproduct.

One pattern under all of it: a trigger feeds a pipeline, a pipeline feeds a cache, a cache feeds a web app, the app emails the right person at the right time — and a non-technical manager keeps it running by editing a spreadsheet.

WHAT TAKING CARE OF PEOPLE DID TO THE NUMBERS

**-53.50
pts**

Turnover, YoY (to 93.33%)

+11.21 pts

Retention, YoY (to 51.72%)

\$84 → \$91

Sales per labor hour (vs \$90 goal)

**2-3 hr →
30 min**

Payroll processing time

For the team

Self-service, English & Spanish — no manager required

Request time off yourself

Put in a PTO request from your phone — pick the dates and submit. No catching a manager, no waiting on a text. Your time off, your request.

Order uniforms with the cost up front

Browse the catalog, pick sizes, and see **exactly what each item costs and what comes out of each paycheck** before you submit. No surprises on payday.

Payroll that's clear

PTO, overtime, and uniform deductions in one place with the math already done — so people can see what they earned and what was taken out, and trust it.

For the operation

The wins that follow when people's time is protected

Schedule Counter

Schedules built around real lives while holding productivity. **SPLH \$84.42 → \$91.02**, past goal since Feb 2025.

Payroll System

One place for the whole pay period — including cross-location overtime reconciled correctly across both stores (FLSA). **Processing 2-3 hr → 30 min.**

Catering Quote & H.E.A.R.D. Log

Catering quotes **10-20 min → 2-3 min**; guest recovery logged in under a minute with repeat-complainer alerts. Food cost gap 1.02% → 0.74%.

How — and why — I build them this way

- **I lead before I build.** The software is the easy part; the tools exist to free the team's time so they can focus on the guest and on each other.
- **Designed for whoever comes after me:** idempotent setup, config in the spreadsheet, maintained by a non-technical operator.
- **Security-conscious:** I run a custom risk-audit scanner and XSS hardening passes over my own code.
- **Honest about scope:** built for two locations today, with a clear view of what would change to run at chain scale.

